

ASHANI AMARASINGHE

CONTACT INFORMATION

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Senior Lecturer (Tenured Assistant Professor) <i>School of Economics, University of Sydney, Australia</i>	Jan 2025 -
Associate Editor <i>Australian Economic Papers</i>	July 2024 -
Lecturer (Assistant Professor) <i>School of Economics, University of Sydney, Australia</i>	July 2022 - Dec 2024
Research Fellow <i>SoDa Laboratories, Monash University, Australia</i>	July 2020 - June 2022

EDUCATION

Monash University, Australia Ph.D (Economics)	2016 - 2020
University of Colombo, Sri Lanka Bachelor of Arts (Economics) First Class Honours	2007 - 2011

PUBLICATIONS

Amarasinghe, A. (2022). “[Diverting Domestic Turmoil](#),” *Journal of Public Economics* 208, Article No. 104608. [WP version](#)

Amarasinghe, A. (2023). “[Public Sentiment in Times of Terror](#)”, *Journal of Development Economics* 162, Article No. 103058. [WP version](#) | [In the media](#)

Amarasinghe, A., Hodler, R., Raschky, P. and Y. Zenou. (2024) “[Key Players in Economic Development](#)”, *Journal of Economic Behaviour and Organization* 223, 40–56. [WP version](#)

Amarasinghe, A., Raschky, P. Zenou, Y. and J. Zhou (2026) “[How Natural Disasters Spread Conflict](#)”, *European Economic Review* 181, Article No. 105194. [WP version](#)

Amarasinghe, A., Nanlohy, S., Morgan, T., Hammond, D. and Bailo, F. (2026) “[Mapping violence perceptions through YouTube comments: A new approach to real-time conflict monitoring](#)”, *EPJ Data Science* 15, Article No. 47. [WP version](#)

Amarasinghe, A., Maitra, P. and Zhong, Y. (2026) “[Partisan Alignment, Insurgency and Public Safety: Evidence from the Indian Red-corridor](#)”, *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, forthcoming

WORKING PAPERS

[Competing for Attention: The Effect of Talk Radio on US Politics](#) with Paul Raschky (Monash University)
[Getting along or getting ahead? The domestic roots of status-seeking in international relations](#) with Kathryn Baragwanath (University of Melbourne) [In the media](#)
[Aid, Interrupted: Conflict Dynamics Following the USAID Suspension in Africa](#), with Annabelle Tan (University of Sydney) and David Ubilava (University of Sydney)

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Missions Misaligned: Colonial Legacies of Social Conflict in Africa, *with David Ubilava (University of Sydney) and Jordi Vidal-Robert (University of Sydney)*
Trading Swords for Courts: Legal Capacity and Civil Conflict, *with Siddharth George (National University of Singapore) and Jingyuan Guo (National University of Singapore)*
Protest, Policing, and Partisan Media: Coverage of U.S. ICE and Immigration Protests, 2025–2026, *with Lukas Wellner (Monash University)*
Climate politics

GRANTS

2025 - School of Economics - University of Sydney, Workshop Grant Scheme “Australasian Public Choice Conference”, with Kadir Atalay
2024-2026 - Australian Research Council Discovery Project Grant DP240101563 “Political Conflict, Inefficient Markets, and Food Crises”, with David Ubilava, Justin Hastings and Andrey Vasnev
2024, 2025 - School of Economics - University of Sydney, Workshop Grant Scheme “Social Conflict and Political Economy Workshop”, with David Ubilava
2023 - School of Economics - University of Sydney, Workshop Grant Scheme “Australian Political Economy Network Workshop”, with Andrew Wait
2023 - School of Economics - University of Sydney, Workshop Grant Scheme “Semi-Periodic Agricultural and Development Economics Research Symposium”, with David Ubilava
2023 - Monash-Warwick Alliance, “Applied Young Economist Webinar Series”, with Paul Raschky, Sascha Becker, Ivan Yotzov and Patrick Healy
2022-2025 - Research start up fund, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, School of Economics, University of Sydney
2021 - Monash Business School competitive ECR Research Grant Scheme, “Quantifying government behaviour through text analysis”
2021 - Monash Business School COVID-19 Disrupted Research Grant Scheme, with Paul Raschky
2021 - Monash-Warwick Alliance Connections Fund, “Applied Young Economist Webinar Series”, with Paul Raschky, Sascha Becker and Ivan Yotzov
2019 / 2017 - Australasian Development Economics Workshop Travel Grant
2017 - Monash University CDES Competitive Travel Grant
2016 - Australia Post-graduate Award/ Research Training Program Scholarship

AWARDS

2025 - Best Referee Award, Economic Journal

2024 - Research Collaboration Award, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, University of Sydney (with David Ubilava, Justin Hastings and Andrey Vasnev)

2024 - Commendation for Teaching Excellence, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, University of Sydney

2023 - Competitive “Research Incubator” Program for early career researchers, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, University of Sydney

2020 - “Purple Letter” for outstanding teaching performance - Monash University

2011 - Professor of Economics Gold Medal for best performance - University of Colombo

CONFERENCES AND INVITED SEMINARS

2026 - Social Conflict and Political Economy Workshop - University of Sydney, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - Australian National University, ASREC Europe Conference - Venice

2025 - Brown University, Northeastern University, University of Toronto, University of Alberta, University of Melbourne, University of Queensland, Monash University, Conference of the Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics - UNSW, Econometric Society World Congress - Seoul, South Korea, Conference of the Australian Society for Quantitative Political Science - Melbourne, Annual Natural Experiment Workshop - Deakin University

2024 - Australian National University, Far Siders Development Seminar, Social Conflict and Political Economy Workshop - University of Sydney, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - University of Melbourne, Australian Conference of Economists - University of Adelaide, Queensland University of Technology, Econometric Society Australasia Meeting - Monash University

2023 - Western Economic Association International Conference - University of Melbourne, Resilient Democracy Lab Workshop - UNSW, Sydney Development Economics Group Workshop - UNSW, Semi-Periodic Agricultural & Development Economics Research Symposium - University of Sydney, Workshop on Big Data in Social Science - University of Sydney, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - Macquarie University, Econometric Society Australasia Meeting - UNSW, Organizational Economics Workshop - University of Sydney

2022 - Sydney Development Economics Group Workshop, Australian National University, Australian Political Economy Network (APEN) Workshop - University of Queensland, ASREC Conference, Melbourne Institute - University of Melbourne, University of Sydney (×2)

2021 - Deakin University, Workshop on Natural Experiments in History, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - Monash University, Annual Conference of the Royal Economic Society, Meeting of the European Public Choice Society

2020 - Applied Young Economist Webinar (AYEW), Oz Virtual Economics Research Seminar (OVERS), Brown Bag Seminar - Monash University

2019 - Monash Business School Doctoral Colloquium, Conflict and Economic Development Workshop - Deakin University, Australian Conference of Economists, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - University of Western Australia

2018 - Annual Conference of the Center for the Study of African Economies - University of Oxford

2017 - Annual Australasian Public Choice Conference - Deakin University, 30th PhD Conference in Economics and Business - University of Melbourne, Summer School in Development Economics - Italian Development Economists Association, Australasian Development Economics Workshop - UNSW

TEACHING

School of Economics, University of Sydney

ECOS3997 Interdisciplinary Impact in Economics : S2 2022 (Instructor), S1 2023 (Unit coordinator and Instructor), S1 2024 (Unit coordinator and Instructor), S1 2025 (Instructor), S1 2026 (Unit coordinator and Instructor)

ECOS3035 Economics of Political Institutions : S1 2023 (Instructor), S1 2024 (Unit coordinator and Instructor), S1 2025 (Unit coordinator and Instructor), S1 2026 (Instructor)

BPPE2000 Intermediate PPE: S2 2026 (Instructor)

THESIS SUPERVISION

School of Economics, University of Sydney

2023 - Sura Majeed (Honours)

2025 - Tiya Banerjee (Honours), Annabelle Tan (Honours, Co-Supervisor)

2026 - Sarita Silva (Honours)

ADMINISTRATIVE RESPONSIBILITIES

2026 - *to date* : Board of Directors - [International Development Economics Association \(IDEA\)](#)

2026 - *to date* : Faculty Representative (FASS) - Sydney Early and Mid Career Academic Network

2026 : Co-organizer - [Australasian Public Choice Conference](#)

2025 - *to date* : Scientific Committee [Australian Political Economy Network](#)

2024 - *to date* : Co-organizer [Social Conflict and Political Economy Workshop](#)

2024 : Co-organizer - [Australian Political Economy Network Workshop](#)

2023 : Co-organizer - Semi-Periodic Agricultural and Development Economics Research Symposium

2022 - 2024 : Co-organizer - [Sydney Development Economics Group](#)

2020 - *to date* : Founder and Co-organizer - [Applied Young Economist Webinar](#)

2021 - 2022 : Member of the Leadership Board - SoDa Laboratories

2020 - 2022 : Social Media Coordinator - SoDa Laboratories

2020 - 2022 : Organizer - SoDa Labs Webinar

2019 - 2022 : Co-organizer - SoDa Labs Reading Group

2017 - 2018: Co-organizer - PhD Seminar Series, Department of Economics - Monash University

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

Adjunct Research Fellow <i>SoDa Laboratories, Monash University, Australia</i>	July 2022 - Present
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Non-Resident Fellow <i>Center for Development Economics and Sustainability, Monash University, Australia</i>	July 2022 - Present
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Member <i>Sydney Environment Institute, University of Sydney, Australia</i>	May 2023 - Present
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Social Media Editor <i>Australian Economic Papers</i>	Aug 2023 - Sep 2025
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REFEREEING ACTIVITY

Journals: Economic Journal, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic Behaviour and Organization, Journal of Population Economics, Economic Modelling, Food Policy, Economic Record, Empirica, Journal of Asian Economics, German Economic Review

Grants: Australian Research Council

Conferences: Member of Scientific Committee (Political Economy) for the 2025 Annual Conference of the Society for Institutional and Organizational Economics at UNSW, Discussant at the Australian Cliometrics Workshop (2024) at UNSW, Discussant at the 37th PhD Conference in Economics and Business (2023) at the University of Melbourne (Best discussant award), Member of Scientific Committee (Political Economy) for the 2023 Australasian Meeting of the Econometric Society; Reviewer and Discussant at Monash University's 2021 Doctoral Colloquium; Panel Member for selecting the best PhD paper at 2021 Australasian Development Economics Workshop

PhD Theses: Nauman Malik (University of Western Australia); Ian Hoefer-Martí (UNSW)

SOFTWARE SKILLS

Stata, R, ArcGIS, Matlab, L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

HNB Assurance PLC, Sri Lanka
Investments & Fund Management

2010 - 2015

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Sinhalese (native)

CITIZENSHIP

Australian and Sri Lankan